2026 Leadership of The United Church

Official Board

Mary Beth Fortunato (U)
Jim Boseck (U)
Dale Zajac (P)
Lydia Busch (U)
Brian Wiser (U)
Sonya Brooks* (P)
Amelia Cunningham (Youth)
Jen Eveleigh (B)
Kevin Wall (U)
Bob Cunningham (B)
Wendy Bacon (U)
Andrew Duncan (B)
Steve Simpson (U)
Anna Zajac (Youth)

Board of Trustees

Dean Williamson (U)
Connie Frye (U)
Steve Smythe (P)
John Eveleigh (P)
Jeannie Blance (P)
Bill Clark (P)
Lynn Bernard* (B)
Wes Posson (U)
Jim Abdallah (U)
Mary Wiser (U)
Joy Van Riper (B)

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Bill Fortunato*
Gail Benjamin
Nancy Gerstner
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Dan Frye
Randy Bacon
Melissa Wormer
Leslie Roof
Sharyn Canham*
Margie Wall

Endowment Trustees

Mark Sheppard
Tom Wormer
Chuck Lowell
Ric Parsons
David Russell
Levi Allen

Church Staff

Office Hours: Monday - Friday, 9:00am to 1:00 pm 585-394-0503

Pastor:	Wade Allen	pastor@uccdga.org
Pastor of Youth & Adult Ministries:	Mark Slomski	mark.slomski@uccdga.org
Director of Family Ministries:	Deb Marshall	deb.marshall@uccdga.org
Director of Care Ministries:	Christy Allen	christy.allen@uccdga.org
Office Manager & Financial Sec.:	Carolyn Russell	office@uccdga.org
Treasurer:	Nancy Lamberson	nancy.lamberson@uccdga.org
Choir Director:	Georgia Sperano	gsperano@rochester.rr.com
Organist:	David Kraft	
Custodian:	Katrina LaRose	

WELCOME TO **THE UNITED CHURCH**

Weekly Bulletin

Sunday

OCTOBER 18, 2026



PHOTO CREDIT: MADISON O'BRIEN
WELLESLEY ISLAND STATE PARK

THE UNITED CHURCH
CANANDAIGUA

THE UNITED CHURCH CANANDAIGUA

Order of Worship for
OCTOBER 18, 2026



Welcome! The United Church is a Presbyterian/American Baptist congregation. We hope you enjoy your visit and let us know if we can help you in any way.

PRELUDE: **"Andante tranquillo" from Sonata No. 3 by Felix Mendelssohn**

WELCOME AND GREETING TO OUR ONLINE CONGREGATION

OUR PREPARATION

Focus of the Day: We are a work in progress, and God is present and moving in the middle of it.

INTROIT: (11:00) "Open Our Eyes, Lord" (Hymn #536) United Church Choir

CALL TO WORSHIP (from Psalm 103)
Leader: Not by might, nor by power, but by my Spirit, says the Lord Almighty.
People: We come to the God who supplies what he asks of us.
Leader: The eyes of the Lord range throughout the whole earth.
People: Nothing we are building is hidden from his sight.
Leader: Who dares despise the day of small things?
All: We are a work in progress, and God is present and moving among us.

***HYMN #349:** **"I Love You, Lord, My Strength, My Rock"**

***OPENING PRAYER:** **Lord Almighty, everything you have ever built among us has come by your Spirit and not by our strength. Forgive us for measuring your work by how fast it moves or how impressive it looks. Send your Spirit again this morning, and give us patience to trust what you are doing in the small and slow places. Let us pray together the prayer Jesus taught us ... Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.**

***WORDS OF ASSURANCE**

***GLORIA PATRI: #807**

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost;
As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be,
world without end. Amen, Amen.

GOD SPEAKS TO US THROUGH THE WORD

FIRST SCRIPTURE READING: **Psalm 104:27-30 (page 596) {A.B. page 671}**

ANTHEM: **(11:00) "Standing On the Promises" arr. Larry Shackley (words on insert)**
United Church Choir, acc David Kraft and June Pettit (piano)

CHILDREN'S MESSAGE: **(11:00)**

SECOND SCRIPTURE READING: **Philipians 1:3-6 (page 1161) {A.B. page 1303}**

Sermon
"A Work in Progress"
(Zechariah 4-6)
Pastor Wade Allen

OUR RESPONSE IN FAITH

***HYMN #367:** **"Day by Day and with Each Passing Moment"**

CCLI Song #104479, Public Domain, Inc., CCLI Lic. #11593017

CONGREGATIONAL PRAYER

OFFERTORY: **Improvisation on "Forest Green"**

***DOXOLOGY: #809**

Praise God from whom all blessings flow;
Praise him all creatures here below;
Praise him above, ye heavenly host:
Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

***HYMN #543:** **"Christ Beside Me"**

BABY DEDICATION: **John Milo Emmal**

BENEDICTION

POSTLUDE: **"Postlude on Bunessan" by Ennis Fruhauf**

* *indicates an invitation to stand for those who are able and comfortable doing so.*

PRAYER SUPPORT IN THE NARTHEX: **(11:00) Trained Care Ministers are available following the service to pray for anyone desiring prayer**

Scriptures for next week, October 25

Sermon Scripture: **Zechariah 7-8**
First Reading: **Psalm 51:15-17**
Second Reading: **Mark 7:5-8**

PRAYER REQUESTS

Health concerns: Chris Van Riper (nephew of Jeff and Joy), Marion Sumpter, Beth Smythe, Claire Sheppard and family, Linda Gilbert and Braeden Flynn, Daniel Zimmerman (nephew of Wendy Bacon), Cheryl Casey, Jenifer Parks (friend of Natalie DeTraglia), Bill Kenyon, Deanna Stocker and Everest Ferrante (Ardelle Bigos relatives), Martha Ashley, Sherry Wesley (cousin of Sue V and Sandi D), Scott Smail (friend of Kathleen Boniak), Sheila Henderson, Phil Greene (Sharon Meyer's brother), Rodney Newfrock (friend of Elaine Allen), Jessica Canham (Sharyn's daughter), Tom Babcock (friend of Jenny Caron), Catherine Kurzdorfer (Adam Thorman's mother), Marcus (friend of Sandi DiCicco), Denise Loy (friend of Kory Massey), Steve Sedlock (Nancy Tharp's brother), Clancy Cragle (Michelle's grandfather)

Cancer: Sumer Miller, Bruce G (brother-in-law of Kathi Nacca), Scott Kesel (friend of Sandi D), David Landon (friend of Sue V and Sandi D), Michael M. (friend of Kathi Nacca), Steve J. (Claire Sheppard's brother), Robbie Bass (Linda Bailey's nephew), Daniel Cage (friend of Wade Allen), Karen Linder (niece of Joyce Laursen), Sue Whybra and Rod Gifford (cousins of Joyce Laursen), Kathy Cool (daughter-in-law of the Pecks), Sophie Snyder (friend of Amelia Cunningham), Chris Alexander (Carolyn Russell's brother), Sarah Hough (daughter of Dianne Beaumont), Laura Fiorito (daughter of Charles and Patti Cagwin), Douglas Cook (Jen Eveleigh's brother), Keith Laursen (Joyce's brother-in-law), Sasha (friend of Megan French), John Tornow (friend of Elaine Allen), Susan Hennessy (Jen Eveleigh's sister), Deb Dawson (Steve Smythe's niece), Jim Davis (Scott's father), Stephen Carges (Paula Traber's brother)

Military Service: Tech SGT Nicholas DelVillano (Frye's son-in-law) USAF stationed in Germany, JJ Callard (USN), US Army CPT Andrew Marlin (Tyler Bosecks husband) home from deployment, LTJG Nick Castiller (USN), MAC Adam Thorman (USN), E6 Cody Wells (USN) home from deployment, TSgt Timothy Peck (USAF)

Missionaries: Carlos Bonilla & Mayra Giovantti – the BGs (Central/South America), Christy Lafferty (Nicaragua), Leodegario Hernandez & Maria Angela Bautista (Bacalar, Mexico pastoral couple), Rev. Nancy and Rev. Shelvis Smith-Mather (South Sudan), Sally Gates (UK), Matt and Meredith Snell (Fort Drum, NY).

Highlights for This Week

- We need **5 dozen pumpkin flavored cookies** for dessert for Youth Club on **October 21,** delivered to the downstairs kitchen 4pm. Please let Deb know if you are willing to bake a dozen or two. Thank you!
- We are collecting **donations for our Youth Club stocking project**. There's more info inside the bulletin.
- **Adult Retreat at Onanda Park - Saturday,** October 24, 9:30am-12:30pm - Join us for worship (by Mike O'Brien), lunch, and Pastor Wally Fleming for our next retreat! Bring your own Bible, pen/journal, and anything you need while at a park (Crouch Hall). A free-will donation ($20 suggested) will be collected at the door during sign-in. A physical sign-up sheet is in the Welcome Center,or you can register online. *Can you help? We need all sorts of support, including worship planning, sign in, set up/tear down, food shopping/serving, etc.*
- **Student-Led Community Prayer Event -** Saturday, October 24, 3pm-5pm - Join Pastor Mark and youth (representing several churches in the Canandaigua area, including ours!) at the Canandaigua KOA Campground for prayer, fellowship and fun activities! The theme is "rooted in prayer" and is the first event planned by Christian students in the area.
- **Our Greeter/Coordinator for October: Dan F.** Please contact Dan or the office if you need help signing up.

Are You Visiting Us Today?



If so, WELCOME to the United Church, we are so glad that you have chosen to worship with us. We invite you to pick up a tan bag (with the United Church logo on it) for yourself/your family to take home and to learn a little bit more about us. **We are so happy that you joined us today and look forward to seeing you again soon!**



Mystery Pledge

We received a monthly pledge of $900 but there's **no name on it.** If this is from you, **please let Carolyn know.**

Families & Children

Do you have little ones with you? **We're glad you're here!** We offer several options to help families worship comfortably together.



Nursery care is available during the service. **Children (infants through 5-years-old) are welcome in the nursery at any time during the service.** All nursery volunteers are background checked. The infant nursery, which is located adjacent to the preschool nursery, is also open and available for parents to use during the service for diaper changes, nursing, etc.

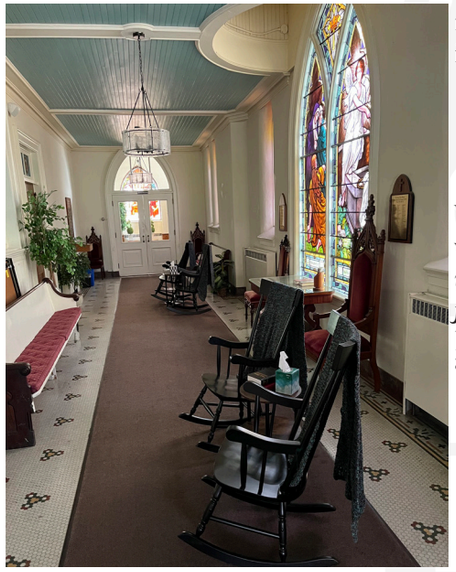
Children's Time is offered after the Children's Sermon on most Sundays for **children in Kindergarten through 2nd grade.**

Learning to Worship/Understanding Your Faith is offered after the Children's Sermon every Sunday through Nov 1 **for children in 3rd through 5th grade.**

The narthex (the area through the back doors of the sanctuary) is also **available throughout the service for children and a caregiver.** This space allows you to continue seeing and hearing the service while giving your child the freedom to move around or make a little noise.



For children who remain in the service, the worship activity cart will be available in the narthex every Sunday. Please be sure to return reusable items.



We invite each family to choose the worship option that works best for them. ***At the same time, we kindly ask that if a child becomes disruptive during the service, they be taken from the sanctuary until they are settled.*** Thank you for helping us create a welcoming worship environment for all.

World Mission Offering

We are still receiving our annual World Mission Offering. One half of this special offering is used by the American Baptist International Missions to support international missionaries and projects in over 70 countries. One half of our giving will be used by the Presbyterian Disaster Assistance program to aid communities affected by disasters. Envelopes were included in your October Lamplighter or simply mark your gift for the World Mission Offering. The fund is also available through our online giving. Thank you!

SHARE THE GOSPEL
Give a million. Reach a million.

Family Promise Gift Cards

Family Promise of Ontario County (FPOC) helps families facing or experiencing ***homelessness*** by providing them a stable place to live, work and financial education, and other support needed to get on their feet. The new FPOC static site on N. Main St is open and active!!! This will have such a positive impact for families living on the edge. God knows and cares! And so do we!



During **October**, our church family would like to help FPOC by **donating $25, $50, or $100 grocery and/or fuel gift cards, or by writing a check to Family Promise.** Families purchase their own groceries, make their own meals, and fuel their own cars, if they have them. Please consider chipping in! Gift cards may be placed in the offering plate or left with Carolyn during office hours. Questions? Please see Cathy or Mary Lou. Please add your prayers to this and Thank You for your consideration!

- The Mission Collection Team

Beaver Camp Fundraising Dinner

November 7, 2026 @ 5:30 pm in The United Church Dining Room

An opportunity to support and learn about the place that has changed the lives and faith of many in our congregation.

Tickets are complimentary, and we graciously ask guests to make a donation to help support the event and its mission. Your generosity is appreciated.
See Bob or Brenda Cunningham for tickets.

BEAVER CAMP
A PLACE TO GROW

Missions **Let the light of Christ shine through you in service to others…**

Foodlink's "Pop-Up Food Pantry"



will welcome volunteers on **Monday, October 19th from 9:00-11:00am** at the Town of Canandaigua Highway Barn, 5440 Routes 5 & 20. As grocery prices increase many new families are seeking emergency food relief from this monthly food distribution. Please consider joining our group from the United Church in "hands-on" community support. Contact Linda W. For more information.



Mission Grocery Donations

With rising food costs, more families are turning to food pantries to help put food on the table. Some are going into credit card debt with grocery expenses. CCIA is experiencing a large jump in the number of 1st time families. Your food donations here will help supply the Salvation Army and CCIA (Canandaigua Churches in Action) Food Pantries. CCIA needs staples such as **spaghetti sauce, canned fruit and vegetables, tuna, and cereal** (which is not always available through FoodLink). Donations can be placed in the Mission Center. Thank you for sharing out of what God has given you!

Youth Club Mission Project



Christmas Stockings for NYC. We are preparing for the Youth Club stocking project. These stockings are given to children along with a presentation of the Gospel message. **Donated items must be new, small and able to fit into a 5"x 9" stocking.** Stocking stuffer ideas: toy cars, yo-yos, small games, bouncy balls, gum, socks, hard candy, hair accessories, jump ropes, coin purses, jewelry, trading cards, pencils/pencil sharpeners, gloves, hats, small stuffed animals or dolls, etc! ***Note***: Coloring books and most small puzzles are too large for these stockings. Please no toy weapons or violent action figures. Please bring your donations to Deb's office. Items need to be donated ***by November 1***. Thank you!!

Exploring Membership Class



In 1942, fire destroyed the First Baptist Church of Canandaigua. A few years later, the Presbyterians down the street opened their doors. That invitation became The United Church.

We'd love to tell you more of that story. Join us for our **Exploring Membership class on Sunday, November 15, from 9:45 to 10:45 AM.** We'll share our history and how our two traditions shape our life today. We'll also walk through the ways you can become a member. Bring your questions!

Whether you're ready to join or just want to learn more, you're welcome.

Sign up online at uccdga.churchcenter.com/registrations/events/3937216 or call the church office.

Thank you and keep in touch!

Marion Sumpter wanted to thank everyone for the lovely send-off. She said it was a special blessing and she was humbled by the kindness and prayers she received. She just couldn't believe how many people lined up to give her hugs. She wanted to share her new address, so you can keep in touch.

Marion Sumpter
24 Allen Ave.
Wyoming, OH 45215



Financial Report through September 30th.

During the first nine months of the year, donations and pledges received were $18,617.29 less than budgeted and $4,993.29 less than the same period in 2025. Total net loss for this period was $28,725.25. Our budget for 2026 predicted that we would have a deficit of $23,621.31, so we have lost an additional $5,103.94 so far.

We have had two months so far this year where we have not even been able to cover all of the costs for the staff let alone any other expenses that we incur on a regular basis. The staff are doing all that they can to cut back on costs. Ultimately, our financial problems are not due to spending more than expected; they are due to a large decrease in pledges and donations that we were unable to predict. **Please prayerfully consider contributing more to help keep our programs going.**

We will begin the budgeting process for 2027 very soon and anticipate having less money to allocate to programs. For this reason, **we are not inviting budget requests for 2027**. At some point this fall, we will contact each program/team/committee and let you know how much we anticipate being able to allocate to you. All groups will be receiving less than they have in the past.

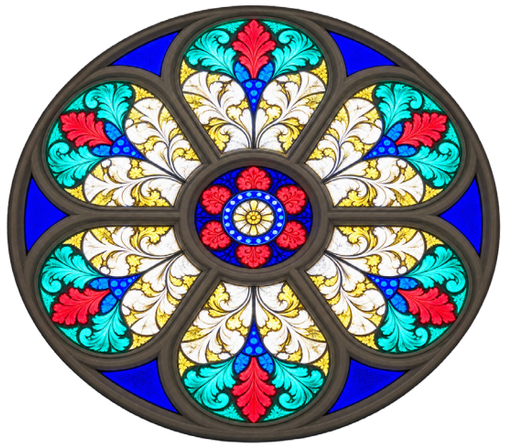
The Finance Committee will hold two informational meetings with regards to the finances on Sunday Oct 18th, one after each service. These are not formal congregational meetings – no votes will be taken.

Stewardship Update

Two weeks remain in the **pledge season for the 2027 year**. We have already had **40** pledges returned, with **$138,453** pledged to Operating and **$37,352** pledged to Missions.

Letters and forms were mailed out but if you have not received them, there are extra pledge form packets in the Welcome Center. Feel free to place them in the offering plate, mail them in, or put them in the box marked "Pledges". Please remember that at the United Church, we have separate pledges for the Operating Budget and the Missions Budget. You decide how your donations are split. Any forms that don't designate how to split the pledge, or say something like "wherever it's needed most", by default go 100% to Operating. So if you would like to support our missions as well, please let us know on your form!

It would be helpful to return pledge forms **by November 1st** if possible, to assist our Trustees in preparing a budget for approval. Watch the future bulletin announcements and the poster of the rose window track our progress!



Standing On the Promises (11:00 service) Anthem

arr Larry Shackley

Standing, standing, I'm standing on the promises of God!

Standing on the promises of Christ my King,
Through eternal ages let His praises ring,
Glory in the highest, I will shout and sing,
Standing on the promises of God.

Chorus
Standing, standing, standing on the promises of
God, my Savior; standing, standing, I'm standing
On the promises of God.

Standing on the promises I cannot fail,
When the howling storms of doubt and fear assail;
By the living Word of God I shall prevail,
Standing on the promises of God.

Chorus

Standing on the promises of Christ the Lord,
Bound to Him eternally by love's strong cord,
Overcoming daily with the Spirit's sword,
I'm standing on the promises of God.

Chorus